Linchuan Xu

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EDUCATION

PhD in Economics, London School of Economics and Political Science 2026
Advisors: Timothy Besley, Maitreesh Ghatak, Alwyn Young
MSc in Economics (with Distinction), LSE 2020
BA in English Literature, Beijing Foreign Studies University 2018

EMPLOYMENT

University of Manchester
Lecturer (Assistant Professor) in Economics 2026 - Present

AFFILIATIONS

Associate, Development Economics Programme, STICERD, LSE

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics, Environmental Economics, Macro-Development

WORKING PAPERS

"The Middlemen of Development? Evidence from Labor Recruitment Agencies in China"

"Organizational Form and River Quality: Theory and Evidence from China", under submission

"Empowerment or Financialisation? The Gains from Financial Inclusion"
with Timothy Besley, Konrad Burchardi, and Maitreesh Ghatak, under submission

"Organizational Purpose and the Dynamics of Motivation"
with Timothy Besley and Maitreesh Ghatak

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

"The Ecological Inequality Trap"

"Making EV Transition Work in India" with Lachi Singh

"The Global Reforestation Atlas" with Yifan Wang

RESEARCH GRANTS

Oct 2026 – Sept 2027	The Global Reforestation Atlas	STEG	£20000
Aug 2025 – Sept 2026	EV Transition in India	IGC	£8015
May 2025 – April 2026	Labor Agencies in China	STICERD	£4683

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026-2027 IFS/UCL/LSE Development Seminar, UCSD India Economics Seminar Series, Science Po (Inequality and the Environment Symposium)

2025-2026 NEUDC, Econometric Society European Winter Meeting, ASSA Poster Session, Manchester, Bristol Applied Economics Meetings (Migration), Durham Development Workshop, RES Annual Conference, SED Annual Meeting, Stanford SITE (Micro and Macro of Labor Markets)

Earlier IFS/UCL/LSE Development Seminar, LSE Environment Week, RES PhD Conference

TEACHING

University of Manchester

ECON60022: Development Microeconomics (PGT)

LSE (Teaching Fellow/Graduate Teaching Assistant)

EC428: Development Microeconomics (MSc)
PP440: Micro and Macro Economics for Public Policy (MPP and MPA)
PP450: Public Organization Theory and Practice (MPP and MPA)
EC411: Microeconomics (MSc)
EC201: Microeconomic Principles (BSc)

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

LSE Class Teacher Award	2026
STICERD Morishima Travel Support	2025
LSE Excellence in Education Award	2023
LSE Economics PhD Scholarship	2020-2025

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Co-organizer, Applied Economics Seminar, Manchester 2026 - Present

REFEREE SERVICE

Economica, European Association of Young Economists